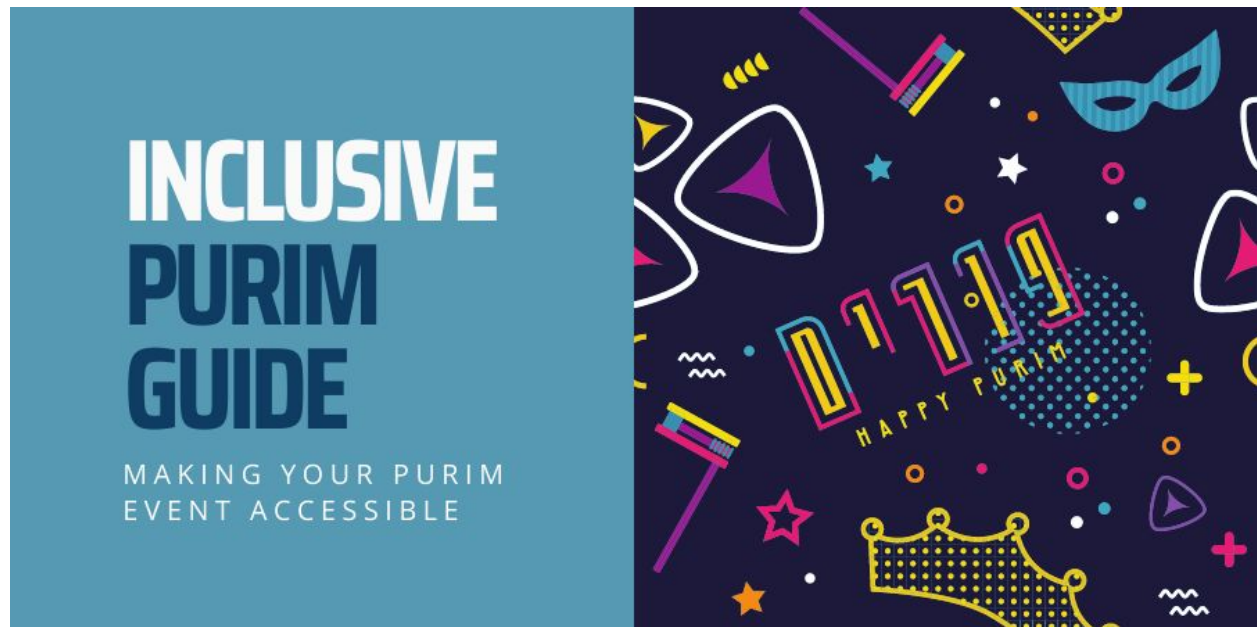




Created by Friendship Circle International

Tips included for:

- Virtual - Making your Virtual Purim Event accessible
- In-Person - Accessible Purim and Sensory Friendly
- Sober Purim

Pre-Event

- On the sign-up form, ask registrants if they need any accommodations to effectively participate in the event. Additionally, provide a name, email and phone number for someone who can assist people with any accommodation's request. Depending on the size and budget of your organization, it may be fair to set a deadline of 48 hours before the event to request any accommodations.

- By offering people the option to request accommodations, it does **not** require you to provide every accommodation requested if your organization is too small to accommodate everything. However, having open communication with individuals requesting accommodations is important, as they may have ideas for workarounds that are doable for your event.
- The invitation also should list **how long** the event will last as well as what the format of the event will be.

Hosting The Event

Most virtual events are hosted on Zoom. It is important to have an accommodation for individuals who do not have access to video conferencing. By offering the option for attendees to **dial in by phone**, people with and without disabilities who do have internet access can still participate.

Live Captioning

Live Captioning is a great way to make your virtual event accessible to people who are hard of hearing or Deaf. There is software that integrates with Zoom and does live captioning automatically.

One recommended software is [REV](#). It’s inexpensive and works well.

Another option is to use **Google Meet** as a virtual platform which has a free option to add closed captioning to all meetings automatically.

Presentations Featured On The Screen

- If there is a PowerPoint(PPT) or other visual aid, then the speaker should describe what is on screen to accommodate individuals who are blind or low vision. Even if you make the PPT accessible, people will not be able to use screen readers for the PPT being shown on screen – only if they are sent their own copy to use.
- If you are using any documents or a Microsoft PowerPoint presentation for your online event, **distribute it to your attendees in advance**. That way, attendees who are blind or have low vision can use screen reader software to familiarize themselves with the materials being presented. If not, the speaker should describe what is on screen before delivering any other talking points.
- If video clips that do not include audio description are played during a presentation, the speaker should explain the visuals before the video begins. This is important not only for

participants who are blind but also because it is unlikely that audio description, which is narration describing what viewers see on screen, can be added after-the-fact to a fast-paced virtual meeting. We recommend this great guide to audio description, including examples: <http://www.superfestfilm.com/audiodescription>.

Tip: PowerPoint has a built-in tool to check accessibility issues in your slide deck and gives you instructions on how to fix them. For help on how to use it, [visit the Microsoft Office Support Site](#).

During The Virtual Event

- The larger the event, the more organization is needed. This is especially important for people with sensory conditions as being on a Zoom Call can be overwhelming. It is vital that the event run in a smooth fashion. Doing a run through before the event can be helpful to catch any issues.
- For events where everyone is visible and able to speak, any individual not speaking should be on mute and a moderator is needed to manage turn-taking. A noisy meeting environment increases listening processing and fatigue for everyone; keeping yourself on mute when not speaking helps all participants.

Accessible Purim - In-Person Event

You may want to include a link to a google form with your registration form in order for people to let you know if they will require accommodations to participate.

Sample accommodation questions to include:

- Do you need any of the following accommodations to participate? (Select all that apply)
 - ASL interpretation
 - Reserved accessible seating
 - Reserved seating for individuals who use a wheelchair
 - Additional information about the event/location/venue
 - Presentation materials provided electronically in advance
 - Accommodation for direct support professional
 - Accommodation for dietary restriction or allergies
 - Other

Prepping For The Event

- Order large print and braille Megillat Esther booklets for the visually impaired. They are available. Through the [JBI- Jewish Braille Institute](#) upon request: 800-433-1531.
- Hire ASL interpreter, if needed. (From where? Cost?)
- Have someone give a synopsis of the story after each perek for those who are visually impaired who can't see the slideshow if you are showing one. (This is fine halachically as long as it's not the person reading the Megillah)
- Ensure any videos have closed captioning so people who are Deaf or hard of hearing can enjoy. YouTube has simple tools to add closed captioning.

Sensory Prepping

- For those who are hesitant to bring their children to the event due to noise or sensory conditions, offer private Megillah reading if Shul is too noisy. Alternatively you can offer a "Quiet" megillah reading where the boos are kept to a minimum.
- [Learn "Boo" in American Sign Language for during the Megillah Reading](#)
- Fidget devices: Provide fidget devices as a silent gragger so people can twirl them when Haman's name is read.

At the Event

- Use [food sensitivity labels](#)
- Pasta graggers! The sound of pasta shaking is not as jarring as a typical gragger sound. It also has the added benefit of fulfilling the Purim mitzvah of "gifts to the poor" when donated to Jewish people in need. (Shalach Manos Graggers)
- Place bubble wrap on the floor. Kids can pop the bubble wrap by jumping, and people who use wheelchairs can roll on it to make it pop.
- Use a green "Go" sign to start the booing and a red "Stop" sign to stop! Write the words on the signs because some people may not be able to distinguish different colors.
- Designate a quiet space, one that's accessible, where parents can bring children, and adults can go, if needed.
- Purim Carnivals are noisy. Tone down the sound by lowering the volume of the music, and eliminate blinking lights or strobes.
- Create a buddy system with older and younger kids who may need extra support to navigate a busy/loud environment.
- Finger puppets can be a good alternative for individuals with sensory conditions and those who do not like to wear costumes.

Food and Drinks on Purim

- Bake inclusively. Hamentashen and *mishloach manot* should ideally be labeled free of gluten, dairy, nuts, and eggs.
- At communal events, always use signage that clearly labels what is in the foods you serve.
- Serve alcoholic beverages in one designated location. Have one person in charge of distributing them responsibly. Provide non-alcoholic mixed drinks, sparkling cider, or grape juice as alternatives to make a *l'chaim*.

Sober Purim

For those struggling with alcohol addiction, Purim can be a trying experience.

Tips For Sober Purim party

- Partner with local organizations helping with addiction if they are in your area such as: Your local [JFS](#), [Blue Dove](#) or [Hamsa](#). It gets the word out.
- Market as a sober Purim party.

Ten Ways You Can Help Alcoholics and Addicts Have a Happy Purim

By Yaakov Ort from Chabad.org

- Here are some time-tested tips on how you can help alcoholics and addicts have a Purim that's safe and sameach (joyous):
- Acknowledge that Purim can be a really rough day for someone trying to stay clean and sober.
 - Affirm that people in recovery do not like being around people who are getting drunk or high, because it's so very tempting to join them.
 - Remember that alcoholics and addicts who relapse often end up in the hospital, jail, or the graveyard, and it always starts with "just one."
 - Without knowing whether or not someone has a drinking problem, be sure to take no for an answer when anybody says "no thanks" to your offer of *l'chaim*. Don't ask twice.
 - Don't ever say: "Hey, I know you don't drink, but even on Purim? It's a mitzvah!"
 - Encourage the alcoholics and addicts you know to attend an alcohol-free Purim meal or event.
 - Help the person get involved in enjoying the mitzvahs of the day: Hearing Megillah (and making lots of noise when they hear Haman's name), sending gifts to friends, giving charity, eating a festive meal.

- Send him or her a mishloach manot basket. Sweets help with cravings, and a present shows that you care.
- Do not ask her what she does to be “unable to tell the difference between cursed is Haman and blessed is Mordechai.” If she asks you what she can do to achieve a state of oblivion, tell her she can take a nap.
- Have a Purim sameach yourself, while recognizing that people can and do celebrate Purim joyously in different ways, and there’s something very special about getting high just on the concept of Purim itself.

Chag Sameach and A Freilichen Purim!